

Change Blindness Starter Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 10-15 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	10-15 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	change-blindness-starter

Big idea: Attention selects reality before we report it.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Two classroom photos where the clock time, board heading, and one desk object change. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Change Blindness Starter Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A slide pair where a key word in a TOK claim changes from 'proves' to 'suggests'. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Change Blindness Starter Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A live scene where a book, chair, or water bottle is moved while students look away. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Attention selects reality before we report it.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	If perception is selective, when should observation be trusted?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Two classroom photos where the clock time, board heading, and one desk object change.
- A slide pair where a key word in a TOK claim changes from 'proves' to 'suggests'.
- A live scene where a book, chair, or water bottle is moved while students look away.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Activity Steps

1. Show Image A for 10 seconds.
2. Switch to Image B for 10 seconds, or alternate quickly between the two.
3. Ask students to write down the change privately before discussing.
4. Reveal the change and ask students what they assumed they had noticed.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: If perception is selective, when should observation be trusted?
- What do we mean when we say, "I saw it with my own eyes"?
- Link to eyewitness testimony, scientific observation, journalism and memory.

Knowledge Questions

- If perception is selective, when should observation be trusted?
- What do we mean when we say, "I saw it with my own eyes"?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with two classroom photos where the clock time, board heading, and one desk object change. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...